



# Position Categories

Policy: HR023  
 Responsible Executive: Vice President for  
 Human Resources, Provost and Senior Vice  
 President for Academic Affairs  
 Responsible Office: Office of Human  
 Resources  
 Approved by: Senior Planning Group  
 Effective Date: 01/10/2022  
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## Policy Statement

Johns Hopkins University is committed to equal opportunity for its faculty, staff and students. The University is committed to providing qualified individuals access to all academic and employment programs, benefits and activities on the basis of demonstrated ability, performance and merit without regard to personal factors that are irrelevant to the program involved. The Human Resources Offices are responsible for all recruiting activity and for approving all employment commitments including salary, position classification and any special conditions of employment for staff. Faculty position descriptions should be submitted to the department chair or designee for review and final approval.

## Who Is Governed By This Policy

All non-represented University faculty and staff.

## Exceptions/Exclusions

Students, post-doctoral fellows, and employees of the Johns Hopkins Applied Physics Laboratory.

## Policy Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to define positions (employee groups) that are categorized by hours worked, the regularity of the work schedule, and the duration of the position.

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## Definitions

|                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Casual (As Needed)</b> | A position where employees are not expected to work more than 27 hours per week. These employees may have a regular/consistent, infrequent or variable schedule and may work as needed throughout the year. They may not work more than 987 hours in a 12-month period. Faculty may not be classified as casual employees.                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Casual (Seasonal)</b>  | A position where employees are hired to satisfy or meet the needs of a department in a cyclical and recurring nature. Seasonal work is short term (lasting no more than six (6) months) and recurs around the same time each year. Seasonal employees may have a regular/consistent, infrequent or variable schedule. They may not work more than 987 hours in a six (6) month period. Employees who work other assignments throughout the year cannot be considered seasonal employees. |
| <b>Full-time</b>          | A regular position planned to last longer than six (6) months that requires a minimum of 28 hours per week to be worked on a regularly scheduled basis or an actual salary of 75% or more of the full-time equivalent salary.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Limited</b>            | <p>A regular position planned to last no more than six (6) months and averages 28 hours or more per week, which cannot exceed 987 hours in a six (6) month period.</p> <p>A regular position planned to last more than six (6) months and averages between 18 and 27 hours per week, which cannot exceed 987 hours in a twelve (12) month period.</p> <p>All faculty positions that are not classified as full or part time are considered limited.</p>                                  |
| <b>Part-time</b>          | A regular position planned to last longer than six (6) months that requires fewer than 28 hours per week, but at least 19 hours per week, to be worked on a regularly scheduled basis. The actual annual salary for a part time faculty position must be less than 75% but at least 51% of the full-time equivalent annual salary.                                                                                                                                                       |

## Policy

Position categories define the University's standard employment groups and should be maintained for all University staff and faculty positions. For staff positions, supervisors should maintain a current position description for every position under their supervision and purview that reflects the department's current needs. This documentation enables all parties to understand the position's duties and responsibilities of a position and should be used as a tool in performance reviews and appraisals. Faculty position descriptions should accurately reflect the qualifications and area of specialization(s) and not be unduly restrictive. This documentation should be developed and reviewed in collaboration with the department chair and any other appropriate individuals, then it should be approved by the department chair or his/her designee.

## Procedures

This section outlines unique considerations and procedures pertinent to certain position categories.

### **I. Casual and Limited Staff: Pay and Recording Working Hours**

Casual staff must be paid based on an established hourly rate with all hours worked submitted through the Cross Application Time Sheet (CATS) timekeeping system. Hours worked cannot be paid with supplemental

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payments. Limited staff may be paid a set amount on the semi-monthly payroll or with an established hourly rate with hours worked submitted through CATS.

Staff paid on an hourly basis are considered non-exempt and subject to the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA).

**II. Working Hours Threshold**

An employee in a casual position who has reached the 987 working hour threshold may only be hired or employed in benefits-eligible assignments at the University. If an employee is anticipated to work beyond 987 hours for all assignments within the University, please consult with a representative from Central Human Resources to determine whether the employee should be converted to full-time, part-time or limited staff. Casual staff who reach this threshold may not continue to work until they are converted to a benefits-eligible status or when their hours fall below the 987 working hours threshold. In order to determine when the working hours threshold has been met, use the employee's hire date and look back 12 months. Following the first year of employment, the measurement period begins with October 15 of the current year to October 15 of the previous year. If Central Human Resources and the department agree to change the classification, neither the employee group nor benefits eligibility will be made retroactively.

**III. Nine (9) or Ten (10) Month Academic Year Positions**

A nine (9) or ten (10) month academic year position ("Academic Year Position") is one that is for a defined period or, alternatively, for the fall and spring semesters with a break in between semesters. Academic Year Positions may be used, for example, for staff positions that support academic year faculty appointments or if a department has fluctuating demands.

**A. Eligibility**

Departments should decide whether an Academic Year Position meets their strategic, financial or operational needs. If so, then the department should determine whether to convert an existing twelve (12) month position to a nine (9) or (10) ten month Academic Year Position, with reasonable and appropriate notice to any incumbents.

**B. Position Scope and Structure**

Employees in Academic Year Positions typically work nine (9) or ten (10) months and are placed on leave without pay status for the three or two non-working months period. The incumbent's standard hours will remain the same during the entire year (inclusive of working months and non-working months). The SAP reason code for the leave of absence without pay will be "Position Schedule".

**C. Base Salary and Annual Review**

Base pay of employees in Academic Year Positions will be pro-rated and paid only during the working months. Annual performance and salary review will be as scheduled and annual salary adjustments will be calculated based on the incumbent's academic year salary.

**D. Work Commitment During Leave of Absence**

Employees in an Academic Year Position may work in another position either within or outside the University during the non-working months. Such employment will have no effect on the employee's benefits eligibility or accrual with respect to the Academic Year Position so long as the employee returns

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to work after the non-working months, as required by the Leave of Absence Policy, and so long as permissible under all benefit plan policies and procedures.

**Policy Enforcement**

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Violations</b>           | It is a violation of this policy not to place employees in the proper category based on the policy definitions above.                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Enforcement</b>          | The circumstances of any alleged misclassification should be investigated by the Office of Human Resources or the Office of Hopkins Internal Audits. Based on the investigation, HR or OHIA may recommend appropriate follow up, including, but not limited to, reclassifying employees and disciplinary action up to and including termination. |
| <b>Reporting Violations</b> | Suspected violations may be reported to the Office of Human Resources or via the Speak2US Compliance Hotline.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

**Related Resources**

|                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------|
| <a href="#">Benefit Eligibility By Position</a> |
| <a href="#">Leave of Absence Policy</a>         |
| <a href="#">Sick Leave Policy</a>               |
| <a href="#">Sick and Safe Leave Policy</a>      |
| <a href="#">Vacation Leave Policy</a>           |

**Contacts**

| Subject Matter                          | Office Name                                                    | Telephone Number | E-mail/Web Address                                                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Position Classifications                | Compensation<br>Schools of Medicine, Public Health and Nursing |                  | <a href="mailto:comp-healthsciences@jhu.edu">comp-healthsciences@jhu.edu</a>                                                                               |
| Position Classifications                | Compensation<br>All other University Schools and Departments   |                  | <a href="mailto:comp-jhucentral@jhu.edu">comp-jhucentral@jhu.edu</a>                                                                                       |
| Policy Clarification and Interpretation | HR Business Services                                           | 443-997-2157     | <a href="mailto:HRBusinessServices@jhu.edu">HRBusinessServices@jhu.edu</a><br><a href="mailto:HealthSciencesLeave@jhu.edu">HealthSciencesLeave@jhu.edu</a> |

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## Appendix

### Position Categories Examples

| Position Categories           | Examples of Work/Schedule/Duration                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Casual (As Needed) or Limited | JHU graduating students who have been employed during the year and continue to work after graduation with an expected duration not to exceed six (6) months.<br>Classification will be determined based on the average weekly working hours.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Casual - Seasonal             | Staff hired to work up to 40 hours per week and are hired for the same purpose each year with a work commitment not to exceed six (6) months.<br><br>Non-JHU students who are hired to work between school semesters or during holiday periods.<br><br>Example: CTY summer hires, Johns Hopkins Summer Jobs programs<br><br>If the seasonal employee returns after a second seasonal assignment during the same academic year (e.g. between semesters), the employee may not be considered seasonal any longer and must be hired into another position category, limited or casual non-seasonal as appropriate. |
| Limited                       | Staff hired to work 37.5 or 40 hours per week on a specific pre-determined project or to back fill for a permanent employee on a leave of absence for a defined period of time with an anticipated end date not to exceed six (6) months.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Limited                       | Faculty member hired to work in a position that does not meet the definition of a full or part-time faculty position.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |